

Nero features three sensors for soil moisture at different root zones and soil temperatures, aiding in precise irrigation and fertigation for crops. It comes with a battery that lasts for nine to ten months. To get a crop-specific fertigation schedule, farmers need to upload a petiole test or soil report in the Fylo app. All the recorded data is saved on the cloud server, year by year, so farmers can access it whenever required.

“Initially using 2G technology, we now utilise 4G across various mobile networks, including Airtel and Jio, depending on the location. The data is sent through the mobile network to our cloud server,” explains Rai.

The startup claims to help farmers get A-grade quality produce with a 20% increase in yield, 90% export quality produce, and a 25% decrease in resources used.

Kairo is priced at ₹45,000, while Nero costs ₹16,000. Both devices are self-installable, wireless, and come with a two-year warranty and a sensor lifespan of five years. Rai says that mid-income farmers recover their investments within the first year of installing the product.

Initially, the early adopters of the technology were primarily large farmers. “Currently, the adoption of this technology is not restricted to large-scale operations; it is accessible to farmers involved in mid- to high-income crops such as apples, *kinnows*, chillies, grapes, guavas, bananas, pomegranates, sugarcane, and cotton, among others,” adds Rai.

The startup has partnered with an electronics contract manufacturer based in Gurgaon, who has additional facilities in Bengaluru and other locations. “We manufacture most sensors, such as leaf thickness, air temperature, humidity, and soil temperature in our partner factory in Gurgaon, India. The only sensor we currently import is soil moisture,” says Sheoran.



(L-R) Co-founders Sumit Sheoran and Sudhanshu Rai

Initially, Fylo directly collaborated with exporters and contract farmers, but since 2021, it has established regular retail and distribution channels. “The government approached us for smart farming projects, offering support of ₹2.3 million to ₹2.5 million. We secured three rounds of funding, with the first round led by 100X.VC and subsequent rounds by Indian Angel Network. Notably, we raised around ₹127 million in 2022 from Ninjacart, Dhanuka, and previous investors,” informs Rai.

The startup has deployed 40 devices globally in Spain, France, Mexico, South Africa, and Turkey through B2B partnership trials. “In France, we’ve partnered with Tera-View, and in Turkey, we’ve joined forces with a company. There’s a trial partnership with a company in South Africa, where we’re providing services to a large network of growers from Gujarat,” adds Rai.

The startup’s immediate focus lies on bringing down the cost of the devices to ensure wider adoption in the market and expanding their advisory services network. To tackle income volatility, Rai revealed the startup’s plans to introduce crop insurance at the farm level. “Leveraging farm and real-time device data, we aim to collaborate with insurance companies, enabling them to assess and refine their insurance methodologies and develop improved products tailored to farmers’ needs at the farm level,” he explains. **EFY**

—Yashasvini Razdan

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